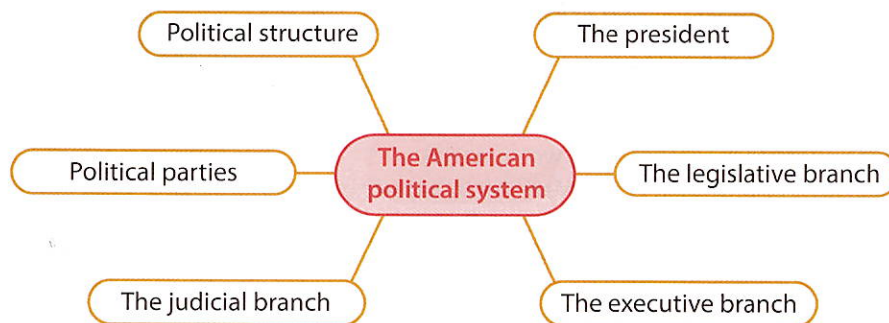


18.5 The Political System (Politický systém)

01 Vytvořte myšlenkovou mapu popisující politický systém ve Spojených státech amerických. Využijte informace z Key Areas.



The US Capitol

KEY AREAS

- **Political structure:** a federal presidential republic, 50 states. **Three branches** – legislative, executive, judicial (a system of checks and balances). **Constitution** – written in 1787, includes the Bill of Rights, can be changed by amendments, guarantees the freedom of speech/press/religion, the right of citizens to carry guns and to a fair trial. **Political parties** – the Democratic Party, the Republican Party.
- **Legislative branch:** **Congress** – the Capitol (the seat), two chambers, makes federal laws, declares wars, approves treaties, establishes and cancels federal courts. **The House of Representatives (lower chamber)** – 435 members (representatives of all states), 2-year terms. **The Senate (upper chamber)** – 100 members (two for each state), 6-year terms.
- **Executive branch:** **The Cabinet** – the executive organ led by the president, consists of 15 executive departments, members appointed by the president with the approval of the Senate. **The president** – the White House (the seat), the head of the executive branch, the commander-in-chief of the military forces, proposes legislative bills, appoints the members of the Cabinet, makes treaties, elected by electors (not citizens) every 4 years for a maximum of two terms. **The vice president** – the president's successor in case of death, resignation or medical problems. **Important presidents** – G. Washington (1st president), A. Lincoln, John F. Kennedy, Barack Obama (1st African American president).
- **Judicial branch:** a complex system of federal and state courts. **Supreme Court** – the highest court, nine members appointed by the president (8 justices and 1 chief justice).

VOCABULARY

- amendment – *dodatek (k ústavě)*
- appoint – *jmenovat*
- approve – *schválit*
- bill – *návrh zákona*
- (the) Bill of Rights – *Listina základních práv a svobod (AmE)*
- cancel – *zrušit, odvolat*
- checks and balances – *pravidla omezující příslušné pravomoci*
- citizen – *občan*
- declare war – *vyhlásit válku*
- department – *ministerstvo*
- (the) Department of Defense – *ministerstvo obrany*
- divide – *rozdělit*
- elect – *volit*
- elector – *volitel pověřený dát hlas jménem voličů ve volbách (AmE)*
- establish – *zřídit, založit*
- freedom of speech – *svoboda projevu*
- (the) House of Representatives – *Sněmovna reprezentantů (AmE)*
- justice – *soudce Nejvyššího soudu*
- law – *zákon, právo*
- legal system – *právní systém*
- military forces – *vojenské síly*
- (the) National Mall – *velký park v centru Washingtonu, DC*
- power – *moc, síla, vláda*
- propose – *předložit*
- (the) right to carry a gun – *právo nosit zbraň*
- successor – *nástupce*
- term – *volební období*
- treaty – *dohoda, smlouva*
- trial – *soudní řízení/proces*

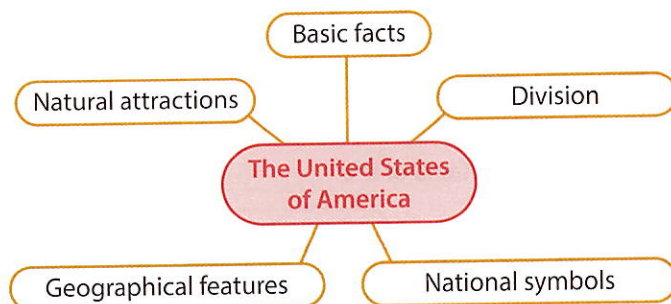
02 Doplňte správná slova. Využijte informace z Key Areas.

- Tell me something about the structure of the American political system. The United States of America is a ¹ presidential republic consisting of ² states. The political system is divided into three branches – legislative, executive, and ³. The branches are regulated by the system of ⁴ and balances, which is defined by the American Constitution. This is the basic legal document that unites the whole system. It can be changed by amendments. The first ten amendments are called the Bill of ⁵. For example, the Bill guarantees the freedom of ⁶, press and religion, and gives citizens the right to carry ⁷. So far, more than 25 amendments have been made. The two major political parties are the Democratic Party and the ⁸ Party.

18. The United States of America (Spojené státy americké)

18.1 Basic Facts and Geography (Základní údaje a geografie)

01 Vytvořte myšlenkovou mapu o Spojených státech amerických. Využijte informace z Key Areas.



KEY AREAS

- Basic facts:** **Position** – Western Hemisphere, North American continent. **Neighbours** – Canada to the north, Mexico to the south. **Area** – 9.8 million km², the 4th largest country. **Population** – 329 million inhabitants. **Capital** – Washington, DC (District of Columbia). **Large cities** – New York City (the largest), Chicago, Los Angeles. **Currency** – US dollar. **Languages** – English, Spanish and others, no official language. **Climatic zones** – arctic (Alaska), temperate (north), subtropical (south), tropical (e.g. Florida).
- Division:** **Regions** – Northeast, South, Midwest, West. **States** – fifty states, 49 are on the continent (Alaska in the northwest is separated by Canada), Hawaii is in the Pacific Ocean.
- National symbols:** **National anthem** – *The Star-Spangled Banner*. **Flag** – the Stars and Stripes (also called Old Glory). **Animals** – bald eagle, bison. **Plants** – rose, oak. **Other** – the Statue of Liberty (a symbol of freedom, hope and friendship, a gift from France).
- Geography:** **West** – mountains (the Cordilleras, the Rocky Mountains, the Cascade Range, the Sierra Nevada), deserts (the Mojave Desert, the Sonoran Desert). **East** – plateaus, lowlands, the Appalachian Mountains. **Central part** – the Interior Plains. **The highest peak** – Denali (in Alaska, 6,190 m). **Seas and oceans** – the Beaufort Sea, the Gulf of Mexico/Alaska, the Atlantic/Pacific/Arctic Ocean. **Rivers** – the Mississippi (the longest), the Missouri, the St. Lawrence, the Niagara (with Niagara Falls), the Rio Grande, the Colorado. **Lakes** – the Great Lakes, the Great Salt Lake. **National parks (NP)** – Great Sand Dunes NP, Yellowstone NP, Yosemite NP, Death Valley NP, Sequoia NP, Grand Canyon NP, Everglades NP.

02 Zakroužkujte správnou možnost. Využijte informace z mapy v úloze 01 a z Key Areas.

- Tell me something about the geography of the USA.**
The USA is located in the south of North America in the **Western/Eastern**¹ Hemisphere. The USA borders on **Mexico/Florida**² to the south and **Alaska/Canada**³ to the north. It's surrounded by the Atlantic, Pacific and **Arctic/Antarctic**⁴ Oceans. In the north, you can find the five **Great/Big**⁵ Lakes called Lakes Superior, Michigan, Huron, Erie and Ontario. The longest river is the **Mississippi/Missouri**⁶ and the highest mountain is **Mojave/Denali**⁷. The west of the USA is mostly mountainous. For example, there are the **Rocky/Appalachian**⁸ Mountains and the Cascade Range there. In the western part, you can also find many **deserts/seas**⁹. The east mostly consists of plateaus and lowlands and the central part is made up of the **Interior/Everglades**¹⁰ Plains.

VOCABULARY

- admire – obdivovat
bald eagle – orel bělohavý
be worth sth – stát za co
(the) Cascade Range – Kaskádové pohoří
ceremony – ceremoniál, obřad
climatic zone – podnebný pás
confirm – potvrdit, upevnit
friendship – přátelství
goddess – bohyně
hope – naděje
landmark – dominanta (města)
natural beauty – přírodní krása
oak (tree) – dub
Old Glory – „Stará sláva“, vlajka USA
patriotism – vlastenectví
plateau – náhorní plošina
(the) Rocky Mountains – Skalisté hory
sandboarding – sjíždění písečných dun na sandboardu
sequoia – sekvoje (strom)
sledding – sáňkování (AmE)
(the) Star-Spangled Banner – Hvězdami posetý prapor (hymna)
(the) Stars and Stripes – hvězdy a pruhy, vlajka USA
(the) Statue of Liberty – socha Svobody
(the) St. Lawrence River – řeka sv. Vavřince
temperate – mírný (o podnebí)
World Heritage Site – památka světového dědictví